

ATHLETES GUIDE

VERSION OF 13/08/2026

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WELCOME LETTER

Greetings and welcome to the 2026 World Triathlon Championship Series Karlovy Vary.

It is my great pleasure to be able to welcome you back to this beautiful region for another edition of WTCS Karlovy Vary racing on this famous course. The historic town enjoys a long relationship with our sport, having hosted several European Cups before stepping up to the World Cup circuit in 2017 and then again to hosting its first Series event last year.

This is a much-loved course that brings the best out of the athletes, and a weekend that showcases the best of our sport at all levels. From Rolava Lake and all the way into and around the stunning city centre, the course is relentless, the hills are demanding and the crowds are loud – just the way we love triathlon to be!



Last year the world's best really stepped up and delivered some nail-biting entertainment as Beth Potter and Henry Graf took the wins. This year, Karlovy Vary will be the final stop ahead of the Championship Finals in Pontevedra, and has the potential to make an even greater impact on the World Championship races, as well as offering valuable points towards LA28 qualification.

The elite racing will undoubtedly inspire the thousands of kids and age-group athletes taking part in this feast of triathlon that always brings so much to the town. Occasions like these are what we rely on for the growth of our sport, and it is always a thrill to see the youngsters falling in love with it, both as they race and watch.

Our huge thanks go to everyone on the Local Organising Committee, the Czech Triathlon Association and all the volunteers and officials who work so hard to stage this event and create an outstanding venue for the athletes. Also to the town and people of Karlovy Vary for what is always such a warm welcome, and I encourage everyone to enjoy the location fully as it hosts the thrilling spectacle of World Triathlon racing. Have a wonderful weekend.

Yours in sport,

Antonio F. Arimany

President, World Triathlon

Dear sports and especially triathlon fans,

Welcome to Karlovy Vary, a world-famous spa town listed as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, which is historically also home to major international sports and cultural events, from festivals to races.

It is no coincidence—for centuries, people from all over the world have sought out our city for their health, and sport goes hand in hand with a healthy lifestyle. For organizers and participants of international events, our city is attractive due to its beautiful environment, built over centuries with an eye for beauty and respect for nature.



The history of Karlovy Vary triathlon races dates back to the 1990s, with the regular City Triathlon taking place here since 2006. Two years later, it became part of the European Cup, since 2017 the World Cup, and for the last two years, it has been part of the World Championship Series.

However, the City Triathlon is not just a single race; it is an entire sporting weekend dedicated to the world's top triathletes as well as Czech competitors, from youth to veterans. There is something for both athletes and spectators—the races feature a rich side program, joined once again by the Vary°Září festival of lights. By day, the city belongs to sports; by night, to fascinating light effects.

I believe you will enjoy Karlovy Vary to the fullest this September weekend. If you are racing, I wish you peak form and a great time. To everyone, without exception, I wish wonderful sporting experiences, lots of fun, and a pleasant time spent in Karlovy Vary.

Ing. Andrea Pfeffer Ferklová, MBA

Mayor of Karlovy Vary

GENERAL INFORMATION

The purpose of the Athlete Guide is to ensure all athletes and team officials are well informed about all procedures concerning the 2026 World Triathlon Championship Series.

Any late information or last-minute changes during the race week will be communicated on the event website: <https://triathlon.org/events/wtcs/karlovy-vary>

KEY DATES

SATURDAY 12th SEPTEMBER

Time	Action	Location
07:45 – 08:45	Elite Swim Course Familiarisation	Lake Rolava – Swim start
09:00 – 10:00	Bike escorted training	Lake Rolava – Swim start
16:00 – 16:30	Elite Athletes Briefing	Spa Hotel Thermal
16:30	Race Pack Pick Up	Spa Hotel Thermal
16:30	Team Medical Meeting	Spa Hotel Thermal

SUNDAY 13th SEPTEMBER

ELITE WOMEN

Time	Action	Location
08:00 – 08:30	Elite Women TA2 Check-in	Theatre square
08:30 – 09:30	Elite Women Athletes Lounge check-in/registration	Lake Rolava – Swim start
08:30 – 09:50	Elite Women Athletes Lounge open	Lake Rolava – Swim start
08:45 – 09:45	Elite Women TA1 Check-in	Lake Rolava – Swim start
09:00 – 09:45	Elite Women Swim Warm-up	Lake Rolava – Swim start
09:50 – 09:59	Elite Women line up and presentation	Lake Rolava – Swim start
10:00	Elite Women Start	Lake Rolava – Swim start
12:10	Elite Women Official award ceremony	Theatre square
12:25	Chocolate Ceremony	Theatre square

ELITE MEN

Time	Action	Location
13:00 – 13:30	Elite Men TA2 Check-in	Theatre square
13:30 – 14:30	Elite Men Athletes Lounge check-in/registration	Lake Rolava – Swim start
13:30 – 14:50	Elite Men Athletes Lounge open	Lake Rolava – Swim start
13:45 – 14:45	Elite Men TA1 Check-in	Lake Rolava – Swim start
14:00 – 14:45	Elite Men Swim Warm-up	Lake Rolava – Swim start
14:50 – 14:59	Elite Men line up and presentation	Lake Rolava – Swim start
15:00	Elite Men Start	Lake Rolava – Swim start
17:10	Elite Men Official award ceremony	Theatre square
17:25	Chocolate Ceremony	Theatre square

ELITE ATHLETES BRIEFING

The Elite Athletes Briefing will take place in the Spa Hotel Thermal

Date:	Saturday 12 th September
Time	16:00 - 16:30

KEY CONTACTS

Title	Name	Email
World Triathlon Team Leader	Enrique Quesada	enrique.quesada@triathlon.org
World Triathlon Technical Delegate	Eva Blomqvist	evabl444@gmail.com
World Triathlon Medical Delegate	Jiri Hamous	hamousj@email.cz
LOC Event Director	Vladimír Malý	vladimir.maly@citytriathlon.cz
LOC - Technical Director	Jakub Rádl	jakub.radl@citytriathlon.cz

EVENT ORGANISER

CITY TRIATHLON KARLOVY VARY z.s.

Address: Šmeralova 320/26, Rybáře, 360 05 Karlovy Vary

Tel: +420 604 480 763

Email: info@citytriathlon.cz

Website: www.citytriathlon.cz

HOST NATIONAL FEDERATION

Česká Triatlonová Asociace / Czech Triathlon Association

Address: Zátokova 100/2, 169 00 Praha - Břevnov

Tel: +420 242 429 259

E-mail: triatlon@triatlon.cz

Website: www.triatlon.cz

TV COVERAGE

Česká Televize – ČT Sport

TriathlonLIVE.tv

Live Broadcast and Live Timing will be provided

RESULTS

Results will be uploaded live on the World Triathlon official website: www.triathlon.org. All the results information will be distributed to the Team Leaders at the LOC Information Office.

PROTEST & APPEALS

Standard procedures will be followed according to the World Triathlon Competition Rules.

ACCREDITATION

The LOC will provide all athletes, coaches and any team medical staff with an official accreditation card or a wristband according to the World Triathlon Event Operational and Technical Requirements.

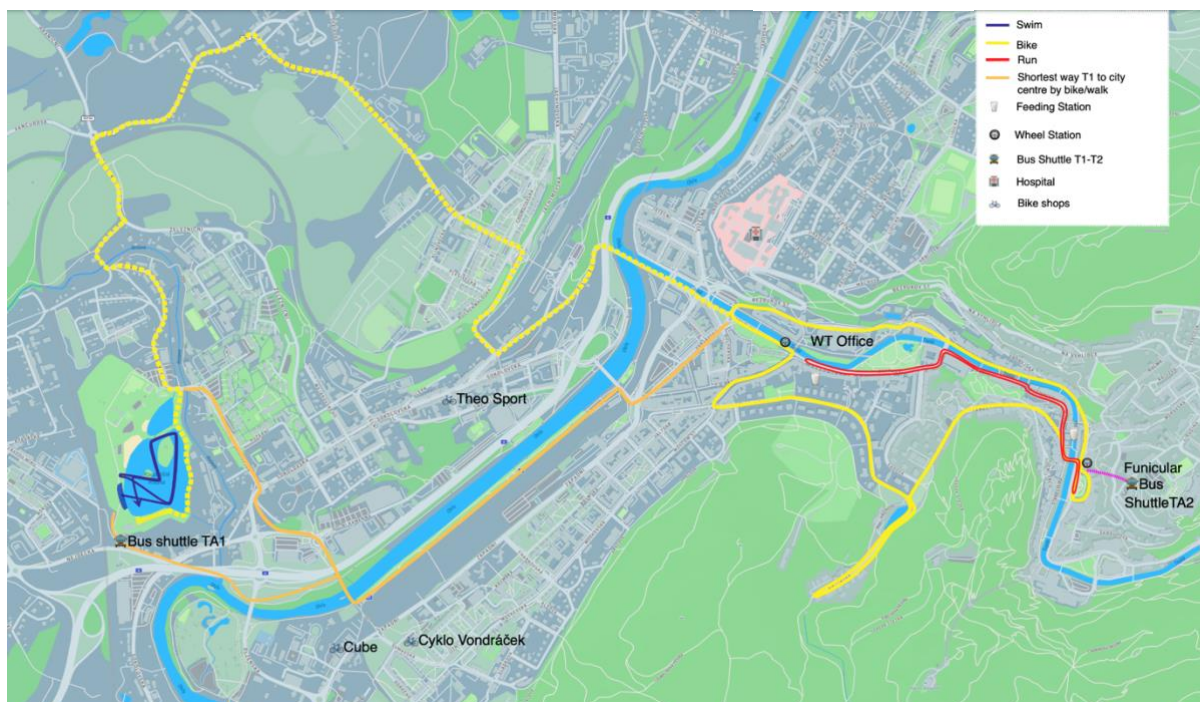
Only accredited persons that have been registered through the World Triathlon system in advance will be given accreditation/wristband and allowed to access certain venue areas. Accreditation cards are number-coded and provide access to specific areas of the competition. All accredited persons are always requested to carry their accreditation cards with them and to show them upon request.

All accreditation cards and wristbands will be distributed on 12th September during the race package distribution at the Spa Hotel Thermal.

I.P.Pavlova 2001/11, Karlovy Vary

VENUE

The race venue is the same as in 2025.
It is spread across the city centre to the lake Rolava.
Venue map can be found on [google maps](#)



Overview of the venue, and race courses.

ELITE ATHLETES LOUNGE

Facilities including the Athletes Lounge Area and toilets are provided for the athletes at the start and a recovery area is available at the finish area. Packages with water, fruit and energy bars will be offered to the athletes before and after the race in the Athletes Lounges and recovery area.

ATHLETE LOUNGE (LAKE ROLAVA) OPENING TIMES

Swim/Bike escorted training:	Saturday 12 th September 07:30 – 09:30
Elite Women's Race:	Sunday 13 th September 08:30 - 09:30 (re-entry until 09:50)
Elite Men's Race:	Sunday 13 th September 13:30 - 14:30 (re-entry until 09:50)

DOPING CONTROL

Doping Control will be performed according to the World Triathlon/WADA rules. Doping control will be located close to the Team wheel station area in the Sparkasse building. ID/passport must be produced by athletes selected for doping control.

MEDICAL SERVICES

First Aid and Emergency Medical Services will be available during the familiarization session and competition schedule. There will be First Aid and Emergency Medical Services at the lake Rolava on competition days.

Medical personnel will be available throughout competition times. Several ambulances will be available to provide emergency transfer to the hospital. A medical area will be provided on-site at the finish area. Only Team Medical Doctors with wristbands will be able to access these areas. Wristbands for Medical Doctors are given at the Race pack pick up, by the Medical Delegate.

Medical services at the venue are free of charge. Treatment in clinics and practices is to be paid by the participants.

Athletes/teams should ensure that they have appropriate medical insurance.

If you require medical assistance during your stay in Karlovy Vary but away from the venue, contact the Emergency Medical Services. In a medical emergency, dial 155 from a mobile phone. The number is free of charge from any telephone.

The hospitals nearest to the Venue and official hotels are:

- Karlovarská krajská nemocnice
Bezručova 1190/19
360 01 Karlovy Vary
+420 354 225 111
- Nemocnice Ostrov
U nemocnice 1161
363 01 Ostrov

BANKING

Banks can be found in the city centre which is a 5-minute walk from the official hotel.

BIKE MECHANIC SERVICE

Our official bike supplier, Kola Chrobák, will have a bike mechanic available at the following times:

SATURDAY 12 th SEPTEMBER		
Time	Action	Location
07:30 – 17:00	After bike escorted training.	Lake Rolava
SUNDAY 13 th SEPTEMBER		
Time	Action	Location
08:30 – 12:00	Elite Women Race	Lake Rolava
13:30 – 17:00	Elite Men Race	Lake Rolava

Please, be aware, that bike mechanics are able to make just a minor service for more serious trouble you can try other bike shops in the city

Other shops in the city are: Cyklo-Vondráček, THEOSPORT, CUBE Store, KOLOFIX

INFORMATION CENTRE / LOC OFFICE

The LOC Information Office is located at the Theatre square in the old Sparkasse building and is open daily, 12th September – 13th September:

OPENING HOURS	
Day	Time
Saturday, 12 th September	08:00 – 18:00
Sunday, 13 th September	09:00 – 19:00

SECURITY

A private security company will be responsible for the venue security. Police will manage the road closures and the traffic throughout the course.

Emergency services telephone number: 112

ACCOMMODATION

There are many accommodations available in Karlovy Vary, we as organiser recommend:

Spa Hotel Thermal

I.P.Pavlova 2001/11, 360 01 Karlovy Vary

+420 359 001 111

<https://www.thermal.cz/en/booking>

Use promo code “citytriathlon” for 20% discount

WEATHER CONDITIONS IN MID SEPTEMBER

Average Water Temperature	20.5°C
Average Air Temperature (High)	19°C
Daylight Hours	12.5 hours
Average Precipitation	90 mm/month

TRANSPORTATION

AIRPORT TRANSFERS

The Organizer will provide transportation from the Václav Havel International Airport Prague from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM on days 11.9. - 13.9. and to the airport from 5:00 AM to 8:00 PM on days 14.9. - 16.9.

The transfer takes around 2 hours.

The transfer is provided by a regular bus line to Karlovy Vary and is free for athletes and coaches until the capacity is exhausted and within the schedule of the bus line.

Free transport cannot be provided outside of the dates and conditions mentioned above.

The Organizer provides free transportation for elite athletes (with bike) and team coaches. The price for any additional member of an escorting team is €20 per person for one journey.

In case of delayed flight free seats are not guaranteed in the next bus transfer.

For free transfer, send your flight information (arrival time and flight number) to the mail address transfer@citytriathlon.cz before 31.8.2026. After this date the cost of the transfer will be €20 per person/way.

LOC also offers an individual transfer at any time. For 1-3 persons for 140€/transfer or for 4-7 persons for 180€/transfer. Please contact transfer@citytriathlon.cz

If you need transfer from/to another airport (Karlovy Vary, Nürnberg, Dresden, Hof) please contact transfer@citytriathlon.cz

PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION

Except for the routes to and from the airport, you'll need a Citybus card or bus tickets to travel within Karlovy Vary. The LOC will provide transportation to the race venue in specific times.

SHUTTLE TRANSPORTATION - schedule

The organiser will provide free shuttle transportation on Saturday 12.9. and Sunday 13.9. See the timetable and map below for locations of the bus stops. There is a funicular from Divadelni namesti followed by bus at Imperial stop (bus waits for funicular) and then to lake Rolava. And vice versa – funicular waits for the bus.

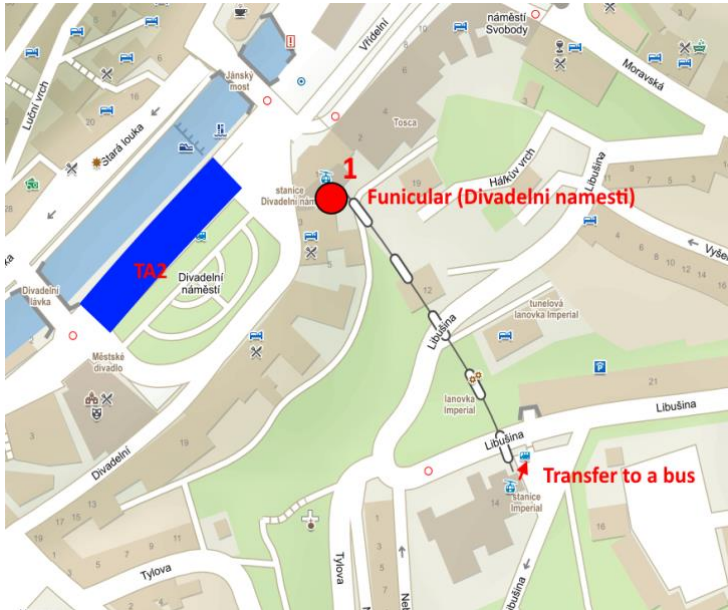
These are **departure times** of the buses – one way takes approx. 20 minutes.

BUS-DIRECT CONNECTION - TIMETABLE

Saturday			Bus Stop			Saturday	
7:20	9:45		Divadelní náměstí (T2)	---			
---	---		Rolava (T1)	9:20			

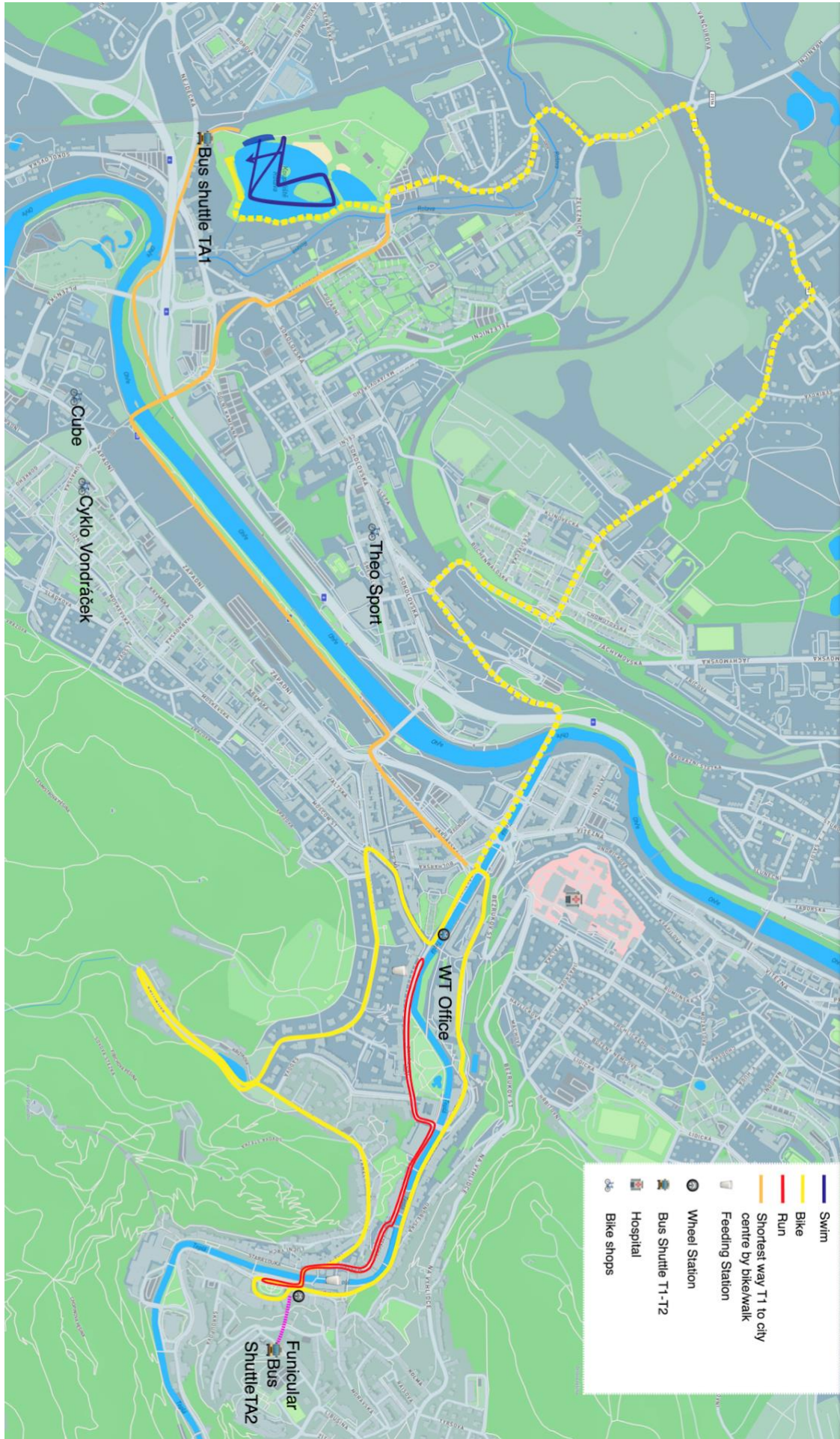
BUS - FUNICULAR - TIMETABLE

Saturday						Bus Stop		Saturday							
11:44	12:38	16:10		↓		Divadelní náměstí (T2)		↑		---	---				
11:50	12:45	16:15				Bus/Funicular - Imperial				14:10	17:44				
---						Bus - Rolava (T1)				13:55	17:30				
Sunday								Bus Stop		Sunday					
7:44	8:38	9:20	12:10	12:38	13:04	13:44	14:25	↓	Divadelní náměstí (T2)		↑	---	---	---	---
8:00	8:45	9:25	12:15	12:45	13:10	13:50	14:30		Bus/Funicular - Imperial			10:38	10:50	15:44	15:44
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---		Bus - Rolava (T1)			10:25	10:35	15:25	15:35



The shortest ways between Lake Rolava and Divadelni namesti/square

There are several ways to get from Rolava Lake to Divadelni namesti. It is different for pedestrians, cyclists or drivers. Please, see the map on the next page where there are ways for pedestrians and cyclists.



TRAINING

SWIM TRAINING

Swimming Pool Mattoni Aréna

Západní 1812/73,

360 01 Karlovy Vary

<https://kvarena.cz/bazenove-centrum/>

Each triathlete is entitled to 2-hour free entry daily. Please present your valid ID with your name.

OPENING HOURS

Monday	12:00 - 21:00
Tue, Wed, Fri:	07:00 - 21:00
Thu, Sat, Sun:	09:00 - 21:00

BIKE TRAINING

The roads are well used by local cyclists and a suggested route would be to cycle in and around the lake Rolava, where one can create a loop and enjoy the picturesque views. The route is not closed to traffic, so you will be cycling at your own risk.

RUN TRAINING

We recommend AC Start stadium for training.

Západní 1781/69,

360 01 Karlovy Vary

Website: <https://kvarena.cz/atleticky-stadion-karlovy-vary/>

Opening Hours:

Weekdays (Mon–Fri):

08:00–16:00 – Public access

16:00–19:00 – Reserved for athletic club training (no access)

19:00–21:00 – Public access

Weekends:

Opening hours are subject to change depending on local athletics competitions.

Saturday:

07:00–13:00 – Reserved for athletic club training (no access)

13:00–19:00 – Public access

Sunday:

09:00–19:00 – Public access

Note: Please check with LOC or directly with the stadium for availability during event week.

Or you can explore beautiful spa forests around the city

COURSE FAMILIARISATION

SWIM

You will be able to familiarise yourself with the swim course on Saturday, 12th September, 07:45 – 08:45. The location will be the same as the start of the race, the lake Rolava. Swimming gear can be moved by LOC to the finish area, where you can pick it up after bike familiarisation.

BIKE

Bike escorted training will be held directly after swim familiarisation. On Saturday at 9am, starting at Lake Rolava.

Video from the bike course is also available on [youtube](#)

The approach from Rolava and two laps will be ridden. Please try to stay in a compact group at all times. At the top of the main climb there will be a point for regrouping, and waiting for the complete pack, before entering the appendix of the course, this is due to the road closure since in the appendix the course goes in the opposite direction of normal traffic. Please carefully respect the directions by police and TOs during the familiarisation.



Map of the appendix section, indicating the regrouping area for the familiarisation.

COMPETITION INFORMATION

COMPETITION RULES

The race will follow the latest published competition rules of the World Triathlon.

INFORMATION ABOUT THE FIELD OF PLAY (FOP)

START

The start area is at the lake Rolava. Athletes will start from a pontoon (0.6 m high) and stand in a starting position 75 cm wide.

The athletes are required to leave their last-minute equipment in the Athletes Lounge. This equipment will be transported by the LOC from the lake Rolava to the finish area.

SWIM COURSE

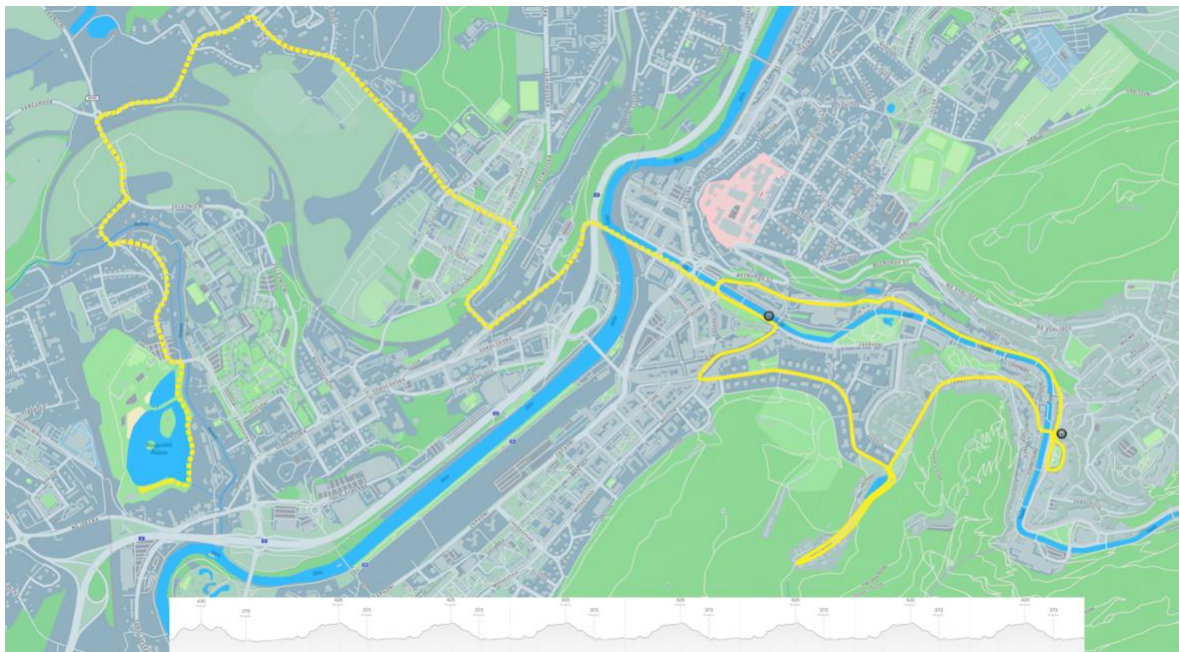
The Swim course will be two anti-clockwise laps of 750 m. The first turn buoy is at 205 m. Swim behind the big island, under the bridge, then turn left between the big and small islands, then turn right towards the wooden pier, where the swim exits. Run on the wooden pier and jump into the water for the second lap. At the end of the second lap turn left on the last buoy to swim exit and to the TA1.



Overview map of the swim course.

BIKE COURSE

The bike course has a course approach (6.5 km) and 7 technically challenging laps of 4.9 km with a total of 40.8 km. The laps are corrugated terrain 80% asphalt and 20% pavement. There is 20% ascent in every lap. The bike course is completely closed from the traffic. Athletes who are lapped are taken out of the race.



Overview map of the bike course, including the approach from lake Rolava.



Map of the bike laps, with the two wheel stations marked.

WHEEL STATIONS

The team wheel station is located close to TA2 and the neutral wheel station is located at Nabrezi Osvobozeni street.

RUN COURSE

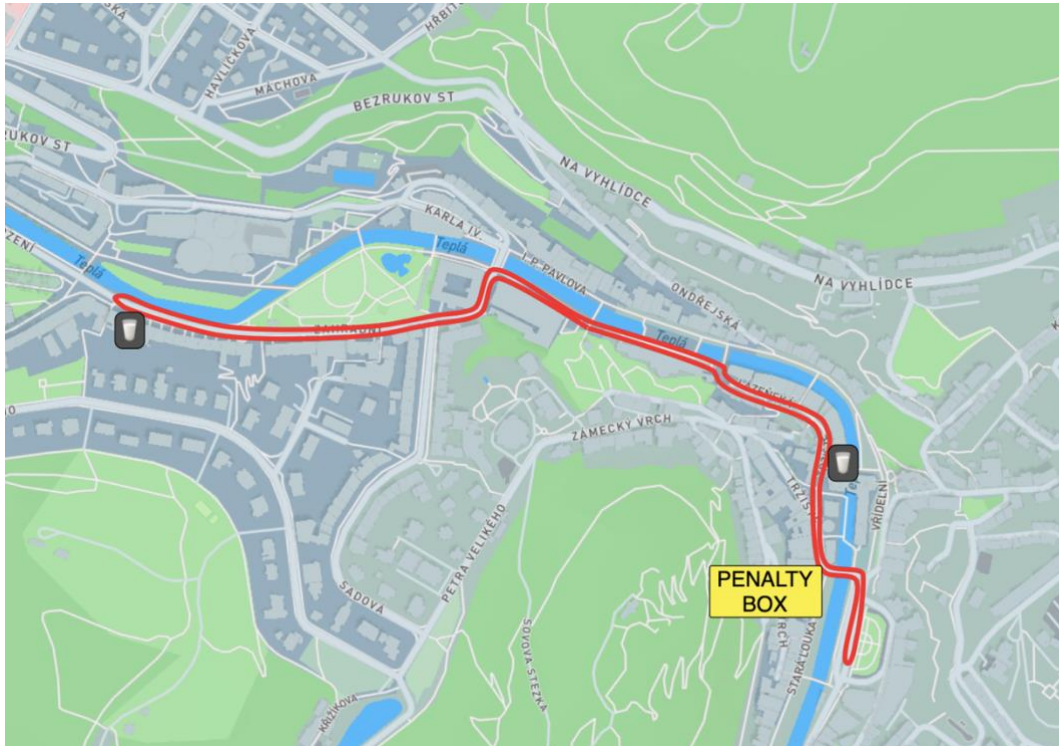
The running part is made up of four 2.5 kilometer long laps. The surface is a mix of asphalt and pavement.

AID STATIONS

There are two aid stations on the run course. First approximately 160 meters from TA2 and second at the farthest turn in Zahradni street.

PENALTY BOX

Close to the TA2 in Staralouka street.



Overview map of the run course, with the two aid stations and the penalty box placement indicated.



Map of the lap and finish area, including the penalty box placement.

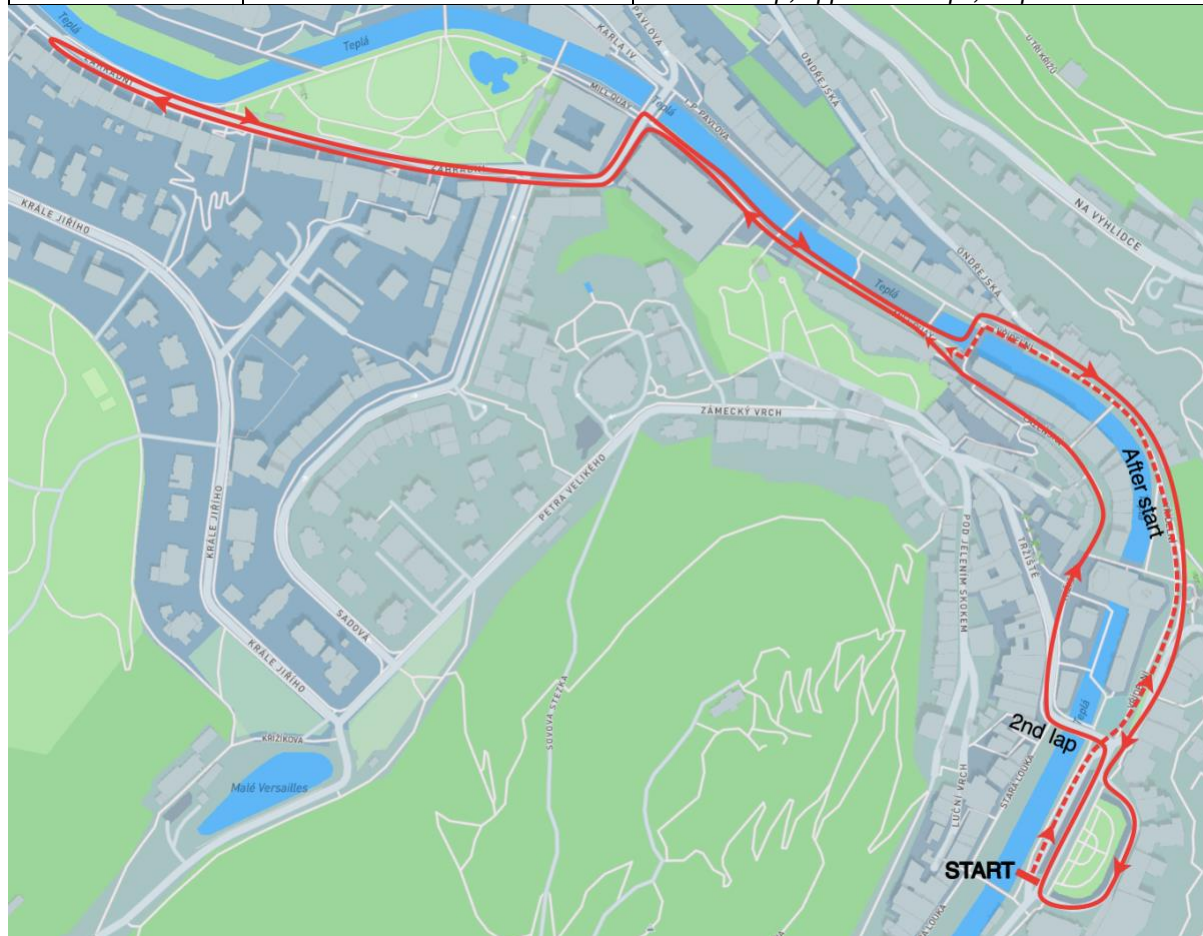
CONTINGENCY PLAN

Scenarios

Scenario 1: Water quality below standard or water temperature below 12°C		
Affected events	Proposed Management	Restrictions
Elite women and men	Both events will be turned into a duathlon - 5/40/10km	1st run would be in opposite direction than regular (right handed U-turns) with minor changes on the course (see map below scenario tables)

Scenario 2: Water temperature between 12,0-12,9 °C.		
Affected events	Proposed Management	Restrictions
Elite women and men	Shortening the event - 0.75/40/10km	One swim lap

Scenario 3: Other adverse weather conditions or other sport/venue issues		
Affected events	Proposed Management	Restrictions
Elite men	Delay or postpone the event. Shortening the event - 0.75/20/5km	Fit within the permitted time frame of the road closure. One swim lap, approach+3laps, 2laps
Elite women	Delay or postpone the event. Shortening the event - 0.75/20/5km	Fit within the permitted time frame of the road closure. One swim lap, approach+3laps, 2laps



Contingency duathlon run course (first run).

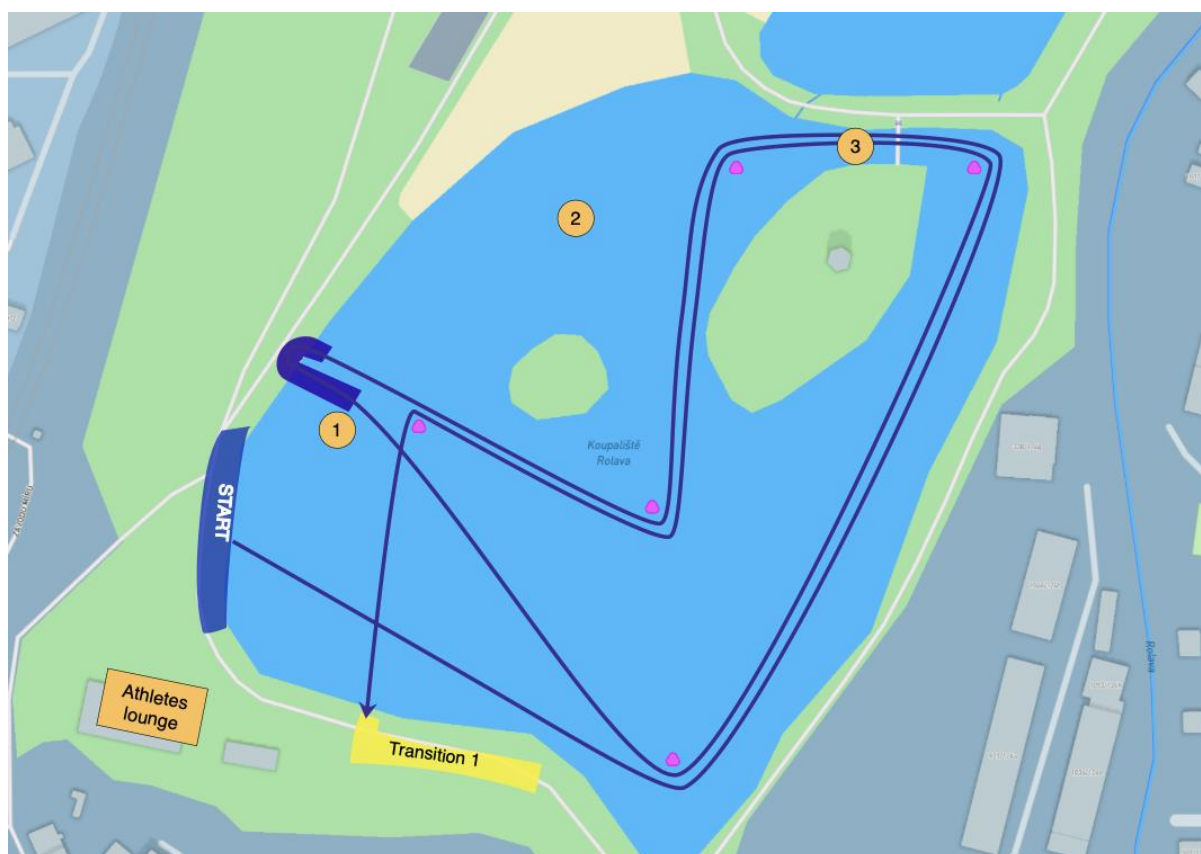
Major emergency situation, e.g. security threat

In case of a major emergency situation – security threat (e.g. terrorist attack), all athletes and personnel will go to the meeting point – the parking place in front of a market Lidl, address: Vítězná 2117/21, Karlovy Vary. The location is in the map below.



WATER QUALITY RESULTS

Date	Place	Chemical test		Microbiological test		
		Ph		e-coli (CFU/100ml)	intestinal enterococci (CFU/100ml)	cyanobacteria (cells/ml)
20.7.	1	9,3		1	7	54 000
20.7.	2	9,2		3	10	123 600
20.7.	3	9,3		72	260	135 060



Points of water quality measuring